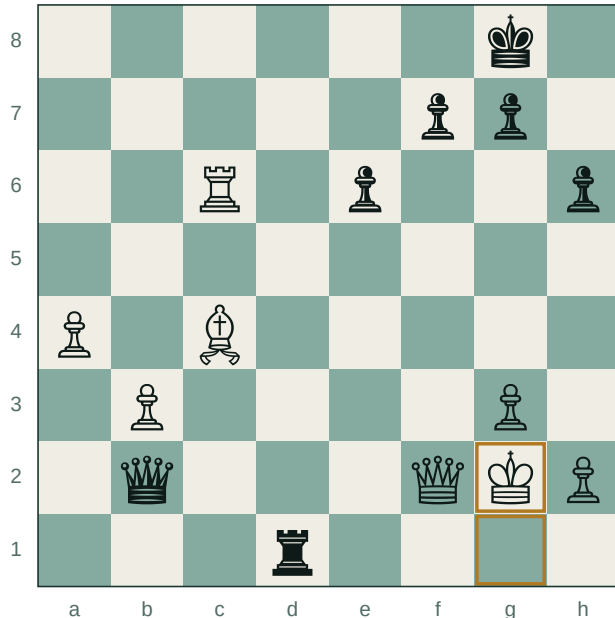


Pins and pressure: Black, move 35

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Kg2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35...Rd2 36. Rc8+ Kh7 37. Bd3+ f5 38. Rc2 Rxf2+

35...Rd2 The rook moves from d1 to d2. Recorded reply: **36.Rc8+**.

36...Kh7 The king moves from g8 to h7. Recorded reply: **37.Bd3+**.

37...f5 The pawn moves from f7 to f5. Recorded reply: **38.Rc2**.

38...Rxf2+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. From f2 it attacks king on g2 and rook on c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from -3 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g2. Absolute pin: queen on f2.